

Your First Conversation

This is your very first session with Nerva OS. We'll keep it short and easy.

By the end of this guide you'll have introduced yourself to your assistant, answered seven quick questions, and watched it do one real task for your business.

Step 1 — Open the Right Folder

Nerva OS lives inside a folder called **my-assistant** on your computer.

1. Open Claude Desktop (the app you installed during setup).
2. When it asks which folder to open, choose the **my-assistant** folder.
3. You'll see a chat window appear.

That's it. You're in.

Step 2 — Say Hello

Click in the chat box at the bottom and type one word:

| hello

Then press Enter.

The assistant will check whether it has met you before. Because this is your first time, it will introduce itself and start a short interview.

What to expect: A warm greeting. A short explanation of what it's about to do. Then the first question.

Step 3 — The Seven Onboarding Questions

The assistant asks seven questions to learn about you and your business. It only does this once. After that, it remembers.

Here is a preview of what's coming.

1. What is your first name?
2. What's the name of your business?

3. What does your business actually do, in one sentence?
4. Who are your customers? (One or two sentences is fine.)
5. What's the biggest thing you're working on right now?
6. How do you like to be spoken to — direct and brief, or warm and detailed?
7. Is there anything you really don't want me to do? (For example: "never send anything without my approval.")

Take your time. Short answers are fine. The assistant will save everything to a memory file that only you can see.

Step 4 — What Happens After the Questions

Once you finish the seven questions, the assistant will do two things.

First, it will summarise back what it learned. Read this carefully. If anything is wrong, just say "actually my business does X" and it will fix the memory.

Second, it will offer to run a small demo task. Usually this is something like writing a single social media post in your tone of voice, or drafting a one-paragraph intro for your website. The demo proves the assistant has properly absorbed your business.

Watch it work. Read what it gives you. This is the moment most owners go "oh, this is actually useful".

Step 5 — What to Try Next

Once the demo is done, you're free to ask for anything. Here are five prompts that work well on day one.

Try this for copy:

| "Write three Facebook posts about my business, in my tone of voice."

Try this for research:

| "Find me three direct competitors and tell me what they do better than I do."

Try this for sales:

| "Draft a follow-up email to a customer who hasn't replied in two weeks."

Try this for planning:

| "Help me plan what I should focus on this week. Ask me what's going on first."

Try this for thinking:

| "I'm thinking about adding a new service. Stress-test the idea with me."

Pick one. Run it. See what comes back.

If Something Feels Weird

It happens. Here are the most common first-session surprises.

"It keeps asking who I am." You probably opened the wrong folder. Close the app, reopen it, and make sure the folder you choose is called **my-assistant**.

"It's writing really long responses." Just tell it: "please keep your answers shorter, around six lines max". It will remember forever.

"It's using words I don't understand." Same fix. Tell it: "please use plain English only, no technical words". It will remember.

"Something broke." Don't panic. Open [09 — Troubleshooting](#) and find the matching problem. Each fix takes under two minutes.

If none of those help, email support@nerva-os.com with a short note about what you tried.

A Note on Tone

The assistant will mirror you. If you're brief, it will be brief. If you're warm, it will be warm. If you swear, it will probably swear back. That's by design. It's your business, not ours.

You can also change its tone any time. Just tell it. It listens.

Next: When you're ready to understand how the assistant chooses the right specialist for each job, read [04 — The Skill System](#).
